

- **Update/ Install an antivirus, an antispyware and a firewall**

If you haven't already installed an antivirus, an antispyware and a firewall, then download the latest version on a computer you are sure is safe and transfer it to your machine. There are a number of good free and paid antivirus, antispyware and firewalls that you can choose from, which are listed in the next section.

Some viruses also stop the user from installing any new programs. If this is the case with your machine, then switch it off, boot into safe mode and install the programs.

If you already have these software installed then update them before disconnecting from the internet.

- **Boot into Safe Mode and run a full scan**

In Safe Mode, the OS loads only the necessary services and drivers which means that viruses and malwares who have added themselves to the startup list of services won't run. To boot into Safe mode in Windows 10, go to Start menu and click the Power button. While keeping the Shift key pressed, select Restart. Your computer will restart and present you with a couple of options. Select Troubleshoot > Advanced options > Startup settings. A new screen will notify you that you have to restart your Windows again to change Advanced boot options which include the Safe mode. Click Restart and select Enable Safe Mode by pressing the F4 key.

Once into the Safe mode, open your antivirus and scan your whole computer. Do the same with the antispyware software. This can be quite a time consuming task and the scans could run for a couple of hours. You can go get some food and finish your other chores in the meantime.

- **Clear browser cache, cookies, and other temporary files and folders, and remove unnecessary software.**

Clearing all these files and folders will not only remove any traces or infected files left behind by the viruses, but also give your computer a significant performance boost. You can either choose to manually clear all these places, or instead download a software like CCleaner to do the same. Download CCleaner off the official site and install it. The software clears a number of temporary folders and files by default, so go through the checklist once before running it. Once you have selected all that you want to clear, select 'Run Cleaner' and let it do its work. Once that is done, go to the Tools section and uninstall all the unnecessary software you don't